

A fresh start

Good writers avoid starting all the sentences in a paragraph in the same way because it sounds monotonous. Sentences can easily be rewritten to stop this from happening.

All these sentences start with the same word, *there*.

There was a chill in the air as Jessica walked through the woods. There was nobody around. There was a sudden growl in the distance.

This passage gives exactly the same information, but in a more interesting way.

There was a chill in the air as Jessica walked through the woods. Nobody was around. Suddenly, she heard a growl in the distance.

Add detail

Adding extra detail using adjectives and adverbs will make a sentence more informative and interesting. The position of an adverb can also be changed to vary the sentence structure.

This sentence isn't very interesting.

Jessica backed away from the monster.

Adding an adverb tells the reader about the way the girl is moving. The adjective describes the mood of the monster.

Jessica nervously backed away from the angry monster.

Moving the adverb changes the structure of the sentence.

Nervously, Jessica backed away from the angry monster.

GLOSSARY

Main clause A group of words that contains a subject and a verb and makes complete sense on its own.

Subordinate clause A group of words that contains a subject and a verb but depends on a main clause for its meaning.



- Add more detail to a sentence by using **prepositions**, which tell the reader **where** something is or **when** something is happening. Prepositions include *about*, *across*, *after*, *at*, and *under*.
- Use a variety of **conjunctions** to link clauses and make sentences **flow** from one to another. These are **connecting words**, such as *so*, *because*, *until*, *whereas*, and *but*.

REAL WORLD

Exciting commentary

Sports commentators often describe the events of a game or race with very short sentences. This makes the commentary as fast-paced and exciting as the event itself. It's particularly effective for radio commentaries when listeners can't see the action, but are relying on the commentary to create the mood.

